

1453

Ottomans capture Constantinople

Ottoman Turks capture Constantinople, rename it Istanbul, and make it their capital.



A book printed by Gutenberg

1455

First European printed book

Johannes Gutenberg, inventor of the printing press, creates the first printed book in Europe. The invention spreads, and by 1500, 20 million books have been printed.

1488

Portuguese sail around Africa

The Portuguese explorer Bartolomeu Dias sails around the southern tip of Africa, which he names the "Cape of Good Hope." Europeans can now sail to India.

1497

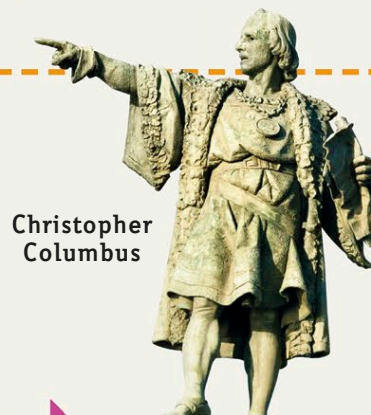
English reach Newfoundland

John Cabot, an Italian, leads an English voyage to Newfoundland in North America.

1493

Spanish found Hispaniola

Columbus founds the first European settlement in the Americas, La Isabela on Hispaniola in the Caribbean.



Christopher Columbus

1492

Columbus reaches the Americas

The Italian Christopher Columbus sails from Spain across the Atlantic and reaches the Americas, which Europeans did not know about before.

1500

Portuguese reach Brazil

Pedro Cabral leads a fleet from Portugal to India, reaching Brazil on the way, which he claims for Portugal.

1501-1504

Michelangelo's David

In Florence, the Italian artist Michelangelo carves his famous sculpture of David.



1510

Transatlantic slave trade

The Spanish take 50 African slaves to Hispaniola, beginning the transatlantic slave trade.

1519-1521

Spaniards conquer the Aztecs

A group of Spaniards led by Hernan Cortes conquers the Aztec Empire of Mexico.

1517

The church divides

In Germany, Martin Luther challenges the teachings of the church, leading to a later split between Protestants and Catholics.

1516-1517

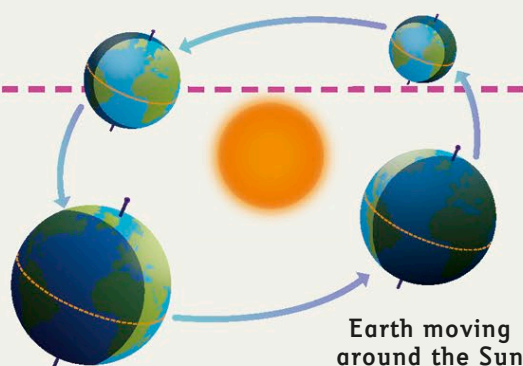
Rise of the Ottoman Empire

Ottoman Turks conquer Arabia, Syria, and Egypt.

1534-1542

French reach Canada

The French explorer Jacques Cartier makes three voyages to Canada, which he claims for France.



Earth moving around the Sun

1543

Copernicus says the earth moves around the sun

Polish astronomer Nicolas Copernicus argues that the earth goes around the sun rather than the other way around.

1609-1616

Blue Mosque

The Ottoman sultan, Ahmed I, builds the Blue Mosque in Istanbul.

1607

English settle in North America

The English found Jamestown in Virginia, beginning their settlement of North America.

1588

Spanish Armada defeated

During a war with Protestant England, Catholic Spain sends an armada (fleet of ships) to invade England, but it is defeated.

Queen Elizabeth I of England

